

Fixing common problems

SEE ALSO

Peripheral devices	36–37 >
Connections	148–149 >
Staying safe online	186–187 >

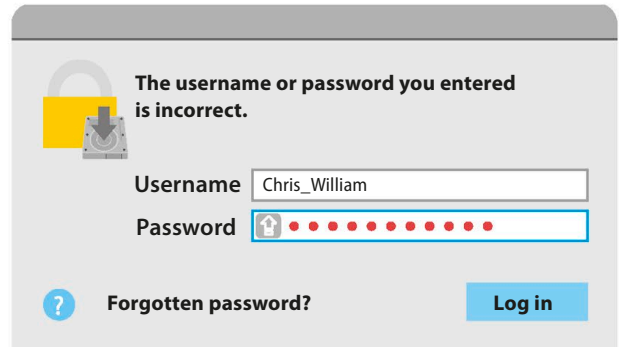
Computer glitches are common and most can be fixed easily and quickly. This is known as troubleshooting. Advice can be found online, or from local computer stores or technicians.

Difficulty logging in

Problems with logging in to a computer can be caused by having pressed the caps lock key, or accidentally trying to log in to another user's account. Forgotten logins can be fixed by using the administrator account to reset the login, or by using a password reset disk.

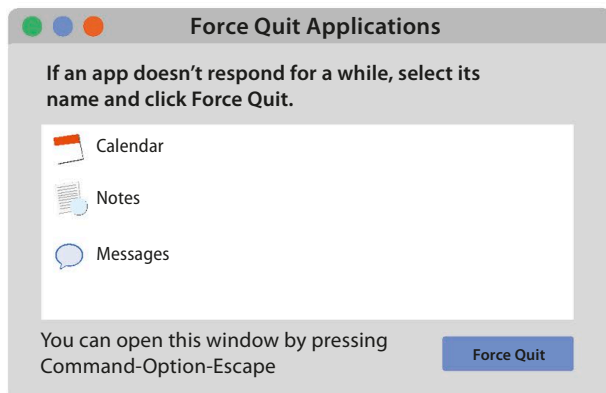
▷ Locked out

Dealing with a forgotten password can be tricky. If the solutions above don't work, seeking advice from a local computer technician is the best plan.



Simple problems

A very common issue is the computer freezing or failing to respond to a mouse or keyboard input. This can usually be fixed by shutting down the machine by pressing the power button for several seconds and then restarting it again. Avoid simply switching off at the mains as this can make matters worse.

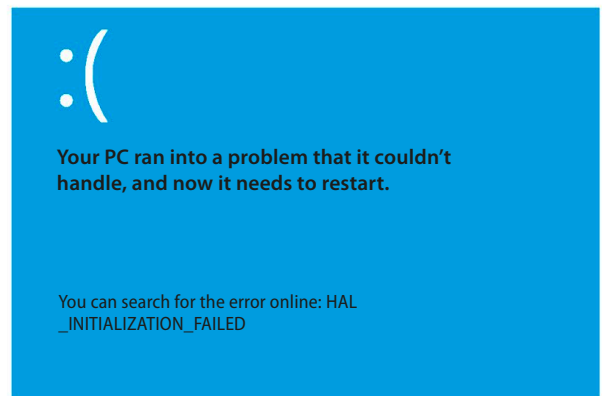


△ Task Manager

If a particular program isn't responding, hold down the ctrl, alt, and delete keys on a computer running Windows or cmd, option, and escape keys on a Mac.

"...there is a **solution** to every **problem**. It may take you a while, but eventually you're going to **find it**."

Tony Cardenas (b. 1953), American politician



△ Blue Screen of Death

Windows shows the "Blue Screen of Death" when a serious fault occurs. After restarting, the computer should be able to guide users towards a solution.